# Kaua‘i – Inland flooding ESF-6 playbook

**Data as of 2026-10-27**

**County:** Kaua‘i · **Hazard:** Inland flooding

**Planning aid. Supports, does not replace, county emergency plans. Not an official shelter list.**

## 1. Summary

**Calculated by open code from public data · see Sources (section 8)**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| People in the risk area<br>**21,404** | May need a public shelter (likely)<br>**1,070** | May need a public shelter (low – high)<br>**428 – 2,354** |
| Speak English less than well (C)<br>**505** | Use power-dependent medical equipment (estimate) (M)<br>**114** | People with a disability (I)<br>**2,241** |
| Age 65 and older (I)<br>**4,730** | People in households without a car (T)<br>**919** | Known 2026 shelter sites usable for this hazard<br>**5** |

Source: CDC/ATSDR Social Vulnerability Index 2022 (ACS 2018–2022 estimates), HHS emPOWER, FEMA National Risk Index v1.20; shelter rates in section 8.

Share of people in the risk area who may need a public shelter: low 2%, likely 5%, high 11.0%. One person can be counted in more than one need. Page 2 explains how to read these numbers.

## 2. Scope: county total vs. one community

**The county total is an upper bound.** It counts the 25% of Census areas in the county with the highest FEMA risk score for this hazard as hit at the same time. Real events usually hit fewer communities.

### Largest single community (the Census areas with the most people who may need a shelter)

| Community (Census area) | People in the risk area | May need a public shelter (low – likely – high) | Speak English less than well | Use power-dependent medical equipment (estimate) | People with a disability | Age 65 and older | People in households without a car |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Līhu‘e<br>Census area 405 | 7,301 | 146 – **365** – 803 | 276 | 33 | 856 | 1,388 | 120 |
| Kekaha / Waimea<br>Census area 409 | 5,172 | 103 – **259** – 569 | 140 | 26 | 410 | 1,077 | 365 |
| Wailua / Wailua Homesteads<br>Census area 402.05 | 4,681 | 94 – **234** – 515 | 40 | 28 | 501 | 1,175 | 67 |

Source: people and needs – CDC/ATSDR Social Vulnerability Index 2022 (ACS 2018–2022 estimates), HHS emPOWER and FEMA National Risk Index v1.20; community names – 2020 Census blocks and places, spellings from USGS GNIS.

To plan for one community, use the first row.

## How to read this playbook

### Example row

| Community (Census area) | People in the risk area | May need a public shelter (low – likely – high) |
|---|---|---|
| Līhu‘e<br>Census area 405 | 7,301 | 146 – **365** – 803 |

Read it as: about 7,301 people live in the risk area of Līhu‘e. If this hazard hits, between 146 and 803 of them may need a public shelter; 365 is the likely number.

### Census area

A neighborhood-sized area the U.S. Census uses, usually 1,200–8,000 people. The number (for example "Census area 308") is its Census ID. Each area is named after the Census place where most of its people live. "near" means no one in the area lives inside a named place; "rural near" means most people live outside named places.

### Low – likely – high

The share of people in the risk area who may go to a public shelter: low 2%, likely 5%, high 11.0%. Where the rates come from: Team assumptions: likely 5%; low 2% (the hurricane planning factor); high 11% (the Lahaina 2023 rate).

### Who has access and functional needs (CMIST)

- **C – Communication:** people who speak English less than well; they may need interpreters and translated messages.
- **M – Medical:** people who use power-dependent medical equipment (an estimate from HHS emPOWER).
- **I – Independence:** people with a disability and people age 65 and older.
- **S – Safety and support:** children and people living in group quarters (in the needs table).
- **T – Transportation:** people in households without a car.

### County total vs. one community

The county total counts the 25% of Census areas in the county with the highest FEMA risk score for this hazard as hit at the same time, so it is an upper bound. Use the "Largest single community" table to plan for an event that hits one community.

### Map

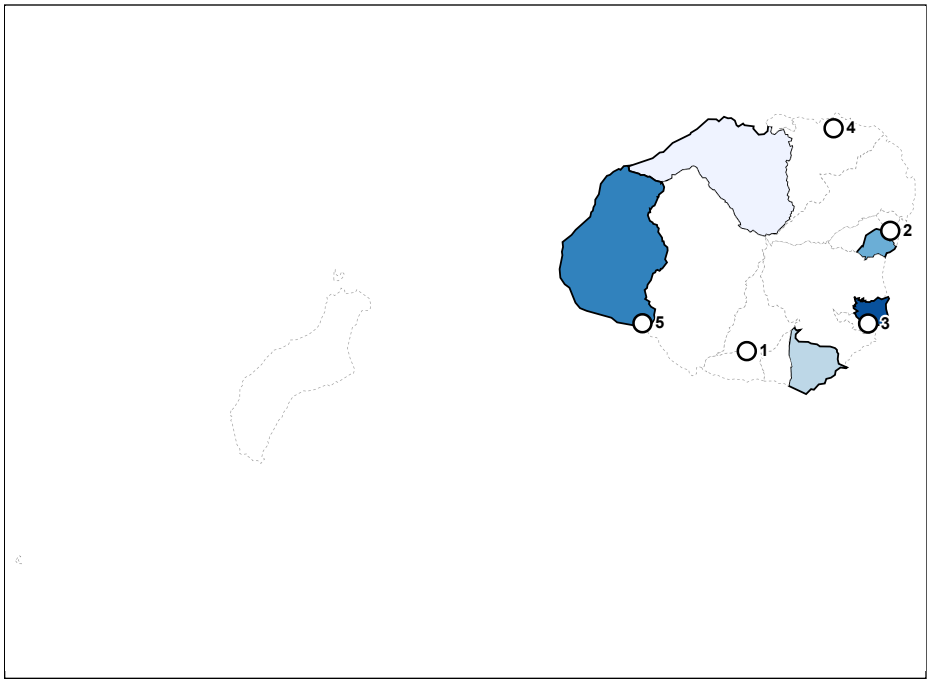
Darker blue means more people with needs, from "Lowest need" to "Highest need". A solid outline marks a Census area in the risk area; a dashed outline is outside it. Symbols: ○ usable site, △ check flood risk, ◇ flood risk not mapped, ⊠ not for this hazard. Numbers on the map match the site key.

### Why population numbers can differ

People in the risk area come from ACS 2018–2022 estimates (through the CDC Social Vulnerability Index 2022). Community names use 2020 Census counts. County totals in the plan use Census estimates for 2025. Each table names its source underneath.

**Every number is a planning estimate. In an event, follow county announcements.**

## 3. Map: people with needs and known sites




**Site key**

**1** = Kalāheo Neighborhood Center (usable)
**2** = Kapa‘a Middle School (usable)
**3** = Kaua‘i High School Gym (usable)
**4** = Kīlauea Neighborhood Center (usable)
**5** = Waimea Canyon Middle School (usable)

- Lowest need (0–310 people)
- Lower (310–607 people)
- Middle (607–636 people)
- Higher (636–940 people)
- Highest need (940–1,285 people)
- Solid outline: Census area in the risk area
- Dashed outline: outside the risk area
- Usable site
- Check flood risk
- Flood risk not mapped (FEMA zone D)
- Not for this hazard

Color = people in the risk area who speak English less than well, use power-dependent medical equipment, have a disability, or live without a car (a person can be counted more than once). No street map: Census area outlines only.

Source: people and needs – CDC/ATSDR Social Vulnerability Index 2022 (ACS 2018–2022 estimates), HHS emPOWER and FEMA National Risk Index v1.20; community names – 2020 Census blocks and places, spellings from USGS GNIS.

## 4. Known sites (opened in 2026 events)

**Compiled with AI from official county releases · verified by team**

| # | Status for this hazard | Site | Address | Why | Times opened in 2026 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | ✓ **Usable** | Kalāheo Neighborhood Center | 4480 Papalina Road, Kalāheo | Outside FEMA high-risk flood zones (zone X) | 1 |
| 2 | ✓ **Usable** | Kapa‘a Middle School | 4867 Olohena Road, Kapa‘a | Outside FEMA high-risk flood zones (zone X) | 1 |
| 3 | ✓ **Usable** | Kaua‘i High School Gym | 3577 Lala Road, Līhu‘e | Outside FEMA high-risk flood zones (zone X) | 1 |
| 4 | ✓ **Usable** | Kīlauea Neighborhood Center | 2460 Keneke Street, Kīlauea | Outside FEMA high-risk flood zones (zone X) | 1 |
| 5 | ✓ **Usable** | Waimea Canyon Middle School | 9555 Huakai Road, Waimea | Outside FEMA high-risk flood zones (zone X) | 1 |

Source: county announcements of sites opened in 2026; FEMA flood zones (Hawai‘i Statewide GIS, State DFIRM); tsunami evacuation zones (Hawai‘i Statewide GIS).

Candidate public schools in this county usable for this hazard: **16**. Sites are places a county has opened before; not every site opens in every event. Always follow current county announcements.

## 5. Needs and proposed partners

Likely estimate. Roles are **proposed – to be confirmed with partner**. The pledged column stays blank until a partner confirms it.

| Need | How many | Unit | Proposed lead | Proposed support | Pledged by partner | Still needed |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cots / sleeping space | 1,071 | cots | County Emergency Management | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS), Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i Department of Education (DOE) – schools, Hawai‘i State Public Library System, American Red Cross, Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Floor space (≤72 h) | 21,404 | sq ft | County Emergency Management | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS), Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i Department of Education (DOE) – schools, Hawai‘i State Public Library System, American Red Cross, Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Floor space (≤2 weeks) | 42,808 | sq ft | County Emergency Management | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS), Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i Department of Education (DOE) – schools, Hawai‘i State Public Library System, American Red Cross, Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Water | 1,071 | gal/day | American Red Cross | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS), County Emergency Management, Hawai‘i Department of Education (DOE) – schools, The Salvation Army, Hawai‘i VOAD (Voluntary Organizations Active in Disaster), Faith-based organizations, Business community | — | confirm with partner |
| Meals | 2,141 | meals/day | American Red Cross | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS), County Emergency Management, Hawai‘i Department of Education (DOE) – schools, The Salvation Army, Hawai‘i VOAD (Voluntary Organizations Active in Disaster), Faith-based organizations, Business community | — | confirm with partner |
| Toilets (≤72 h) | 27 | toilets | County Emergency Management | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS), Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i Department of Education (DOE) – schools, Hawai‘i State Public Library System, American Red Cross, Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Toilets (≤2 weeks) | 54 | toilets | County Emergency Management | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS), Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i Department of Education (DOE) – schools, Hawai‘i State Public Library System, American Red Cross, Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Shelter staff | 77 | staff per shift | County Emergency Management | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS), Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i Department of Education (DOE) – schools, Hawai‘i State Public Library System, American Red Cross, Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies, Hawai‘i VOAD (Voluntary Organizations Active in Disaster), Office of Hawaiian Affairs (OHA), The Salvation Army, Philanthropy (foundations and donors), Business community | — | confirm with partner |
| Power outlets for power-dependent residents | 6 | outlets | Hawai‘i Department of Health (DOH) | County Emergency Management, Health care organizations (incl. managed health care), Utilities | — | confirm with partner |
| Accessible transport | 919 | people in no-vehicle households at risk | County Emergency Management | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS), Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i Department of Transportation (DOT), Business community, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Pet space – dog households | 157 | households with a dog | County Emergency Management | Hawai‘i VOAD (Voluntary Organizations Active in Disaster) | — | confirm with partner |
| Pet space – cat households | 91 | households with a cat | County Emergency Management | Hawai‘i VOAD (Voluntary Organizations Active in Disaster) | — | confirm with partner |
| Children's area | 246 | children in shelter | County Emergency Management | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS), Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i Department of Education (DOE) – schools, Hawai‘i State Public Library System, American Red Cross, Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies, Hawai‘i Department of Health (DOH), Health care organizations (incl. managed health care), Philanthropy (foundations and donors) | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Ilocano | 10 | people with limited English in shelter | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS) | County Emergency Management, Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i State Public Library System, Hawai‘i Department of Health (DOH), Office of Hawaiian Affairs (OHA), Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |

| Need | How many | Unit | Proposed lead | Proposed support | Pledged by partner | Still needed |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Interpreters – Tagalog, Filipino | 6 | people with limited English in shelter | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS) | County Emergency Management, Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i State Public Library System, Hawai‘i Department of Health (DOH), Office of Hawaiian Affairs (OHA), Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Spanish | 2 | people with limited English in shelter | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS) | County Emergency Management, Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i State Public Library System, Hawai‘i Department of Health (DOH), Office of Hawaiian Affairs (OHA), Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Japanese | 2 | people with limited English in shelter | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS) | County Emergency Management, Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i State Public Library System, Hawai‘i Department of Health (DOH), Office of Hawaiian Affairs (OHA), Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Marshallese | 1 | people with limited English in shelter | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS) | County Emergency Management, Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i State Public Library System, Hawai‘i Department of Health (DOH), Office of Hawaiian Affairs (OHA), Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Hawaiian | 1 | people with limited English in shelter | Hawai‘i Department of Human Services (DHS) | County Emergency Management, Hawai‘i Emergency Management Agency (HI-EMA), Hawai‘i State Public Library System, Hawai‘i Department of Health (DOH), Office of Hawaiian Affairs (OHA), Faith-based organizations, Other state and county agencies | — | confirm with partner |

Source: likely estimate × planning factors in section 8 (Florida Division of Emergency Management 2010; AVMA 2022 for pets).

## 6. Decision points

Proposed – supports, does not replace, county plans.

| When | Trigger | Action | Owner (proposed) | Support |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **BEFORE** | Annual pre-positioning review (no official product)<br>County (sets the date) | Mark shelters inside a FEMA Special Flood Hazard Area or zone D for site check; choose alternates. | County Emergency Management (each county) | doe, dhs |
| **DURING** | Flash Flood Warning<br>NOAA NWS Honolulu | Open only shelters outside the SFHA; accessible transport where roads allow; multilingual messages. | County Emergency Management (each county) | dot, red_cross, dhs |
| **AFTER** | Warning cancelled or all clear<br>County / NWS / PTWC | Recovery sheltering and feeding for displaced households. | American Red Cross | hawaii_voad, salvation_army, faith_based |

Source: National Weather Service, Central Pacific Hurricane Center and Pacific Tsunami Warning Center product definitions (links in section 8).

## 7. Priority outreach and languages

### Top 10 Census areas by number of people with needs

| # | Community (Census area) | People in the risk area | Use power-dependent medical equipment (estimate) | People with a disability | Speak English less than well | People in households without a car | Needs total (a person can be in more than one column) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Līhuʻe<br>Census area 405 | 7,301 | 33 | 856 | 276 | 120 | 1,285 |
| 2 | Kekaha / Waimea<br>Census area 409 | 5,172 | 26 | 410 | 140 | 365 | 940 |
| 3 | Wailua / Wailua Homesteads<br>Census area 402.05 | 4,681 | 28 | 501 | 40 | 67 | 636 |
| 4 | Kōloa / Poʻipū<br>Census area 406.03 | 2,972 | 19 | 284 | 49 | 254 | 607 |
| 5 | Hāʻena / Hanalei<br>Census area 401.04 | 1,278 | 7 | 190 | 0 | 113 | 310 |

Source: people and needs – CDC/ATSDR Social Vulnerability Index 2022 (ACS 2018–2022 estimates), HHS emPOWER and FEMA National Risk Index v1.20; community names – 2020 Census blocks and places, spellings from USGS GNIS.

### Languages: people age 5 and older who speak English less than "very well" (Kauai + Maui)

Kauaʻi and Maui share one language list: the Census survey reports both counties (and Kalawao) as one area, so they cannot be separated.

| Language | People | Margin of error (90%) |
|---|---|---|
| Ilocano | 9,131 | ±1,439 |
| Tagalog, Filipino | 5,074 | ±926 |
| Spanish | 1,711 | ±554 |
| Japanese | 1,339 | ±417 |
| Marshallese | 633 | ±488 |
| Hawaiian | 515 | ±289 |

Source: ACS PUMS 2019–2023 5-year (validated against DBEDT Data Book 2024, Table 1.44).

Pre-approved message templates: none yet; no machine translation without human review.

## 8. Sources and assumptions

### Planning factors

| Factor | Value | Source or team assumption |
|---|---|---|
| Shelter-seeking rate – Hurricane | 0.02 / 0.03 / 0.05 | South Carolina EMD, 2026 Hurricane Response Annex G (planning factors 2%, 3%, 5%) |
| Shelter-seeking rate – Wildfire | 0.02 / 0.05 / 0.112 | high = observed Maui 2023: 1,418 people in shelters on Aug 11, 2023 (Maui Now) / Lahaina CDP population 12,702 (2020 Census) = 0.1116, rounded to 3 decimals = 0.112 (so the calibration event falls inside the band). low and central are team_assumption. |
| Shelter-seeking rate – Tsunami | 0.02 / 0.05 / 0.11 | team_assumption: central 5%; low 2% = hurricane planning factor (SCEMD); high 11% = observed Maui 2023 no-notice total-loss rate |
| Shelter-seeking rate – Inland flooding | 0.02 / 0.05 / 0.11 | team_assumption: central 5%; low 2% = hurricane planning factor (SCEMD); high 11% = observed Maui 2023 no-notice total-loss rate |
| Shelter-seeking rate – Coastal flooding | 0.02 / 0.05 / 0.11 | team_assumption: central 5%; low 2% = hurricane planning factor (SCEMD); high 11% = observed Maui 2023 no-notice total-loss rate |
| Footprint – Hurricane | all | Hurricanes affect whole islands (Lala, Lowell 2026). |
| Footprint – Tsunami | tsunami_zone_share | Population share inside the State standard tsunami evacuation zone. Extreme zone is reported separately. |
| Footprint – Wildfire | nri_top_share_by_county (25%) | Counties lead mass care, so each county plans for its own highest-risk tracts (team_assumption). |
| Footprint – Inland flooding | nri_top_share_by_county (25%) | Counties lead mass care, so each county plans for its own highest-risk tracts (team_assumption). |
| Footprint – Coastal flooding | nri_top_share_by_county (25%) | Counties lead mass care, so each county plans for its own highest-risk tracts (team_assumption). |
| floor sqft 72h | 20 | Florida DEM Sheltering Guidance Aid (2010): emergency evacuation shelter, <=72 h |
| floor sqft 2wk | 40 | Florida DEM (2010): short-term shelter, <=2 weeks |
| water gal per day | 1 | Florida DEM (2010) |
| meals per day | 2 | Florida DEM (2010): two hot meals a day plus snacks |
| persons per toilet short term | 20 | Florida DEM (2010): short-term shelter, <=2 weeks |
| power outlets per power dependent person | 1 | team_assumption |
| persons per toilet 72h | 40 | Florida DEM (2010): emergency evacuation shelter, <=72 h |
| Staffing ratios | client registration 1:165, dormitory management 1:100, meal service 1:110, mental health 1:250, public health medical 1:200, security 1:100, sanitation 1:200, children area 1:12 | One staff member per N shelter residents, minimum 1 when the shelter is open. Florida DEM (2010) staffing metrics; the source marks them as recommendations. |
| dog owning household share | 0.446 | AVMA U.S. pet ownership statistics (2020 data). Verified in 2022 AVMA Pet Ownership and Demographics Sourcebook, p. 3: 'Dog ownership increased by 6% from 38.4% (2016) to 44.6% (2020)'. The first url did not resolve when checked 2026-10-27. |
| cat owning household share | 0.26 | AVMA (2020 data). Verified in 2022 AVMA Pet Ownership and Demographics Sourcebook, p. 3: 'Cat ownership increased slightly from 25% in 2016 to 26% in 2020'. |

### Data sources

| Source | Fetched | URL / file |
|---|---|---|
| CDC/ATSDR Social Vulnerability Index 2022, census tracts | 2026-10-27 | https://onemap.cdc.gov/onemapservices/rest/services/SVI/CDC_ATSDR_Social_Vulnerability_Index_2022_USA/FeatureServer/2 |
| FEMA National Risk Index v1.20, census tracts – Hurricane | 2026-10-27 | https://services.arcgis.com/XG15cJAlne2vxtgt/arcgis/rest/services/National_Risk_Index_Census_Tract_Hurricane_Hazard_Type_Risk_Ind |

| Source | Fetched | URL / file |
|---|---|---|
| FEMA National Risk Index v1.20, census tracts – Wildfire | 2026-10-27 | https://services.arcgis.com/XG15cJAlne2vxtgt/arcgis/rest/services/National_Risk_Index_Census_Tract_Wildfire_Hazard_Type_Risk_Index |
| FEMA National Risk Index v1.20, census tracts – Tsunami | 2026-10-27 | https://services.arcgis.com/XG15cJAlne2vxtgt/arcgis/rest/services/National_Risk_Index_Census_Tract_Tsunami_Hazard_Type_Risk_Inde |
| FEMA National Risk Index v1.20, census tracts – Inland Flooding | 2026-10-27 | https://services.arcgis.com/XG15cJAlne2vxtgt/arcgis/rest/services/National_Risk_Index_Census_Tract_Inland_Flooding_Hazard_Type_Ris |
| FEMA National Risk Index v1.20, census tracts – Coastal Flooding | 2026-10-27 | https://services.arcgis.com/XG15cJAlne2vxtgt/arcgis/rest/services/National_Risk_Index_Census_Tract_Coastal_Flooding_Hazard_Type_F |
| Tsunami Evacuation Zones (Statewide GIS) | 2026-10-27 | https://geodata.hawaii.gov/arcgis/rest/services/Hazards/MapServer/2 |
| Extreme Tsunami Evacuation Zones (Statewide GIS) | 2026-10-27 | https://geodata.hawaii.gov/arcgis/rest/services/Hazards/MapServer/12 |
| HHS emPOWER – electricity-dependent DME, county level | 2026-10-27 | https://services2.arcgis.com/ZQ4jTQn6k7VPXEwO/arcgis/rest/services/HHS_emPOWER_REST_Service_Public/FeatureServer/2 |
| Hawaii Statewide GIS – State DFIRM (FEMA flood hazard areas, 6/15/26) | 2026-10-27 | https://geodata.hawaii.gov/arcgis/rest/services/Hazards/MapServer/6 |
| County shelter activations 2026 (official county releases) | see table | data/sources/county_shelter_activations.csv |
| 2020 Census Block Assignment File, place/CDP (tract community labels) | 2026-10-27 | https://www2.census.gov/geo/docs/maps-data/data/baf2020/BlockAssign_ST15_HI.zip |
| 2020 Census PL 94-171 block population P1_001N (tract community labels) | 2026-10-27 | https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/decennial/2020/data/01-Redistricting_File--PL_94-171/Hawaii/hi2020.pl.zip |
| ACS PUMS 2019-2023 5-year (detailed languages) | 2026-10-27 | https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/acs/data/pums/2023/5-Year/csv_phi.zip |
| DBEDT State of Hawaii Data Book 2024, Table 1.44 (validation) | 2026-10-27 | https://files.hawaii.gov/dbedt/economic/databook/2024-individual/01/014424.pdf |
| Partner list: Hawaii DHS, HAIC 2026 ESF-6 challenge statement | 2026-10-15 | HAIC_AI Challenge_Submission_DHS_Disaster_2026.pdf |
| pre season hurricane | | https://www.nhc.noaa.gov/cphcmission.php |

| Source | Fetched | URL / file |
|---|---|---|
| hurricane watch | | https://www.nhc.noaa.gov/aboutgloss.shtml |
| hurricane warning | | https://www.nhc.noaa.gov/aboutgloss.shtml |
| tsunami warning | | https://www.tsunami.gov/?page=message_definitions |
| flash flood warning | | https://www.weather.gov/safety/flood-watch-warning |
| red flag warning | | https://www.weather.gov/safety/wildfire-ww |
| coastal flood warning | | https://www.weather.gov/okx/marinedef |

Privacy: aggregate census-tract and county data only. No individual records. Public facility names and addresses only.

## 9. How AI built this plan

| Task | What AI did | What people checked | Evidence |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Shelter list** | An AI assistant (Claude) compiled the 2026 shelter list from county press releases and news reports: site name, address, event, date and pet policy, with the source URL on every row. News reports were then matched to official county releases. Result: 32 activation records for 30 sites (2 sites opened twice), all citing an official county source. | A team member reviewed the table and read the county pages that block automated tools (2026-10-27). Open code then grouped, located and hazard-checked the sites. | county_shelter_activations.csv on GitHub: https://github.com/HAIC-2026/Kahu-Ola/blob/main/data/sources/county_shelter_activations.csv |
| **Data discovery** | Datatrove's AI discovery chat found the current FEMA National Risk Index (v1.20) Census-area layers and field names, the HHS emPOWER county fields, and Census tables and download routes. | The team downloaded every dataset from its official source, checked the field names and recorded each URL and fetch date. | Sources (PLAN.md §3): https://github.com/HAIC-2026/Kahu-Ola/blob/main/PLAN.md#3-data-sources-and-dates |
| **Software** | Most of the code and tests were written with an AI coding assistant (Claude / Claude Code). | The team reviewed, ran and committed every change. 30 commits, 25 of them co-authored by Claude; 182 automated tests. | Commit history on GitHub: https://github.com/HAIC-2026/Kahu-Ola/commits/main |
| **Multilingual messages** | AI drafted 15 English source messages and translations into 9 languages (Chinese, Hawaiian, Ilocano, Japanese, Korean, Pidgin (Hawai‘i Creole English), Spanish, Tagalog/Filipino and Vietnamese). It made no drafts for Chuukese and Marshallese. | Approved: 0 of 180 messages. Every translation needs a native-speaker reviewer (assigned: Vietnamese: Kim Quynh Do); Chuukese and Marshallese need human translators. | Messages tab: https://shelters.kahuola.org/#messages<br>Message files on GitHub: https://github.com/HAIC-2026/Kahu-Ola/tree/main/data/sources/messages |

### What AI does NOT do

- **Compute the numbers.** Every count and estimate is calculated by open, deterministic code from public data (the scripts/ folder in the repository).
- **Decide shelter status.** Usable / check / not for this hazard comes from fixed rules on official FEMA flood maps and State tsunami evacuation zones.
- **Run during an emergency.** The app and playbooks work offline. No AI runs at that time and no live data is fetched.

### Message drafts by language

| Language | Messages | AI drafts | Need a human translator | Approved |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| English | 15 | 15 | 0 | 0 |
| Chinese | 15 | 15 | 0 | 0 |
| Chuukese | 15 | 0 | 15 | 0 |
| Hawaiian | 15 | 15 | 0 | 0 |
| Ilocano | 15 | 15 | 0 | 0 |
| Japanese | 15 | 15 | 0 | 0 |
| Korean | 15 | 15 | 0 | 0 |
| Marshallese | 15 | 0 | 15 | 0 |
| Pidgin (Hawai‘i Creole English) | 15 | 15 | 0 | 0 |
| Spanish | 15 | 15 | 0 | 0 |
| Tagalog/Filipino | 15 | 15 | 0 | 0 |
| Vietnamese | 15 | 15 | 0 | 0 |

Counts are computed when the site is built, from the message files and the repository history up to commit 69e5f16. Every message, with its status, is in the Messages tab of the web app (https://shelters.kahuola.org/#messages).